

SEDAR 59 South Atlantic Greater Amberjack

- Develop methods to characterize length and age composition of greater amberjack observed on videos from the SERFS fishery-independent survey. Trap sampling of greater amberjack was limited and potentially biased due to size selectivity of the gear.
- Implement a systematic age sampling program for both the general recreational and commercial sectors. Age samples were important in this assessment for identifying strong year classes but sample sizes were relatively small and disparate in time and space.
- Better characterize reproductive parameters including age at maturity, batch fecundity, spawning seasonality, and spawning frequency. Mature female biomass was the measure of reproductive potential for greater amberjack in the assessment, but may be biased if reproductive parameters vary significantly with size or age.
- Age-dependent natural mortality was estimated by indirect methods for this assessment of greater amber jack. Telemetry- and conventional-tag programs may be possible for greater amberjack to improve estimates of estimating mortality.
- Better characterize the migratory dynamics of the stock and the potential for distribution shifts.